Typography · Spacing · Radius · Elevation · Motion

01 · TYPOGRAPHY

Spectral · Barlow · JetBrains Mono

Light mode | Dark mode

Prove it. Don't claim it.	**DISPLAY** size: clamp(2.75rem,5.5vw,4.5rem) weight: 500 leading: 1.05 font: Spectral Hero headlines only.
Your verified work record	**H1** size: 2.5rem / 40px weight: 500 leading: 1.10 font: Spectral Page titles, profile names at largest size.
Equal terms, not equal pedigree	**H2** size: 1.875rem / 30px weight: 500 leading: 1.15 font: Spectral Section headings, modal titles.
TypeScript — Skill Trust	**H3** size: 1.375rem / 22px weight: 600 leading: 1.25 font: Barlow Card titles, panel headers. Switches to sans
Recent contributions	**H4** size: 1.0625rem / 17px weight: 600 leading: 1.30 font: Barlow Subsection labels, sidebar group headers.
Skilient turns real academic and project work into a verifiable professional record — the opposite of a self-written CV nobody can check.	**BODY-LG** size: 1.125rem / 18px weight: 400 leading: 1.65 font: Barlow Landing page introductory paragraphs only.
Ananya's TypeScript skill has been endorsed by three witnesses, each linked to a specific pull request you can verify independently.	**BODY** size: 0.9375rem / 15px weight: 400 leading: 1.60 font: Barlow Default body copy.
Skills only surface through witnessed endorsements. You cannot self-declare proficiency.	**BODY-SM** size: 0.8125rem / 13px weight: 400 leading: 1.55 font: Barlow Helper text, secondary descriptions inside cards.
WITNESSED ENDORSEMENT	**LABEL** size: 0.75rem / 12px weight: 600 leading: 1.40 tracking: 0.08em Form labels and table headers only. Not for section eyebrows.
14 Sep 2026 · 2 hours ago	**CAPTION** size: 0.6875rem / 11px weight: 500 leading: 1.45 font: Barlow Timestamps, meta information. Smallest readable text.
`a3f8c2d feat: add verified-skill endpoint to /api/v2`	**CODE** size: 0.8125rem / 13px weight: 400 leading: 1.55 font: JetBrains Mono Commit hashes, repo names, file paths, API endpoints — real data only.
`github.com/opendata/api-v2/pull/247`	**CODE-SM** size: 0.6875rem / 11px weight: 400 leading: 1.50 font: JetBrains Mono Inline commit references, short hashes, attribution IDs inside tight components.

Light mode | Dark mode

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TYPE TOKEN REFERENCE

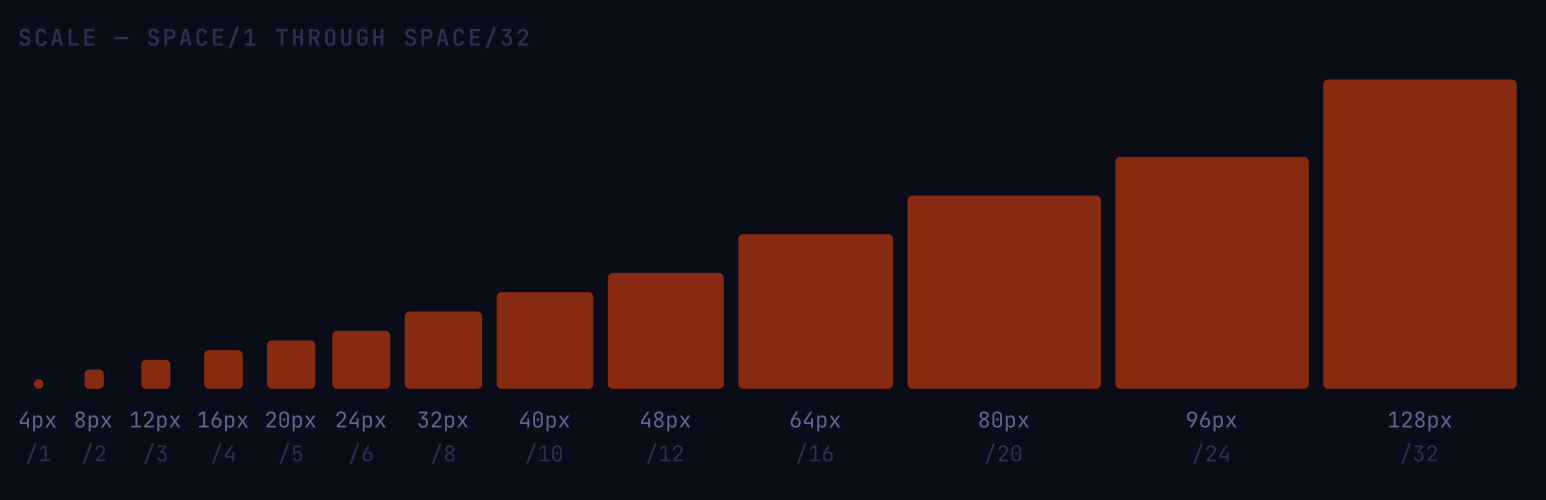
text/display	clamp(2.75rem,5.5vw,4.5rem) / Spectral 500 / lh 1.05 / ls -0.025em	
text/h1	2.5rem (40px) / Spectral 500 / lh 1.10 / ls -0.02em	
text/h2	1.875rem (30px) / Spectral 500 / lh 1.15 / ls -0.015em	
text/h3	1.375rem (22px) / Barlow 600 / lh 1.25 / ls -0.005em	
text/h4	1.0625rem (17px) / Barlow 600 / lh 1.30	
text/body-lg	1.125rem (18px) / Barlow 400 / lh 1.65	
text/body	0.9375rem (15px) / Barlow 400 / lh 1.60	Default body
text/body-sm	0.8125rem (13px) / Barlow 400 / lh 1.55	
text/label	0.75rem (12px) / Barlow 600 / lh 1.40 / ls 0.08em	Form labels + table headers only
text/caption	0.6875rem (11px) / Barlow 500 / lh 1.45	Minimum readable
text/code	0.8125rem (13px) / JetBrains Mono 400 / lh 1.55	Real data only
text/code-sm	0.6875rem (11px) / JetBrains Mono 400 / lh 1.50	Inline refs

02 · SPACING

4px base unit — 13-step scale

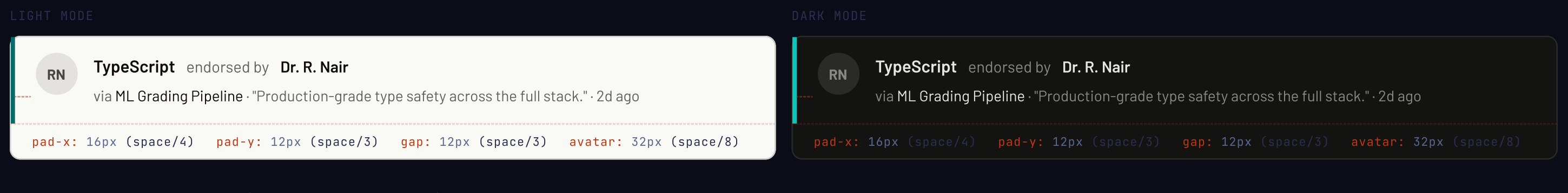
Every spacing value is a multiple of 4px. Named semantic slots map abstract steps to real component contexts: spacing/chip (4–8px) → spacing/component (12–16px) → spacing/card (20px) → spacing/section (64–96px). No free-range values anywhere — every gap is a step from this scale.

SCALE — SPACE/1 THROUGH SPACE/32



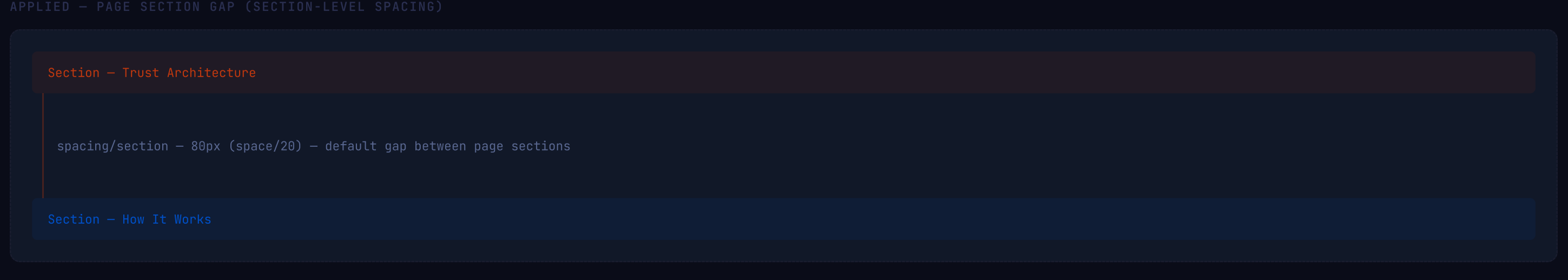
APPLIED — ENDORSEMENT ROW (COMPONENT-LEVEL SPACING)

LIGHT MODE | DARK MODE



RN
TypeScript endorsed by Dr. R. Nair
via ML Grading Pipeline · "Production-grade type safety across the full stack." · 2d ago
pad-x: 16px (space/4)
pad-y: 12px (space/3)
gap: 12px (space/3)
avatar: 32px (space/8)

APPLIED — PAGE SECTION GAP (SECTION-LEVEL SPACING)



Section — Trust Architecture
spacing/section — 80px (space/20) — default gap between page sections
Section — How It Works

SPACING TOKEN REFERENCE

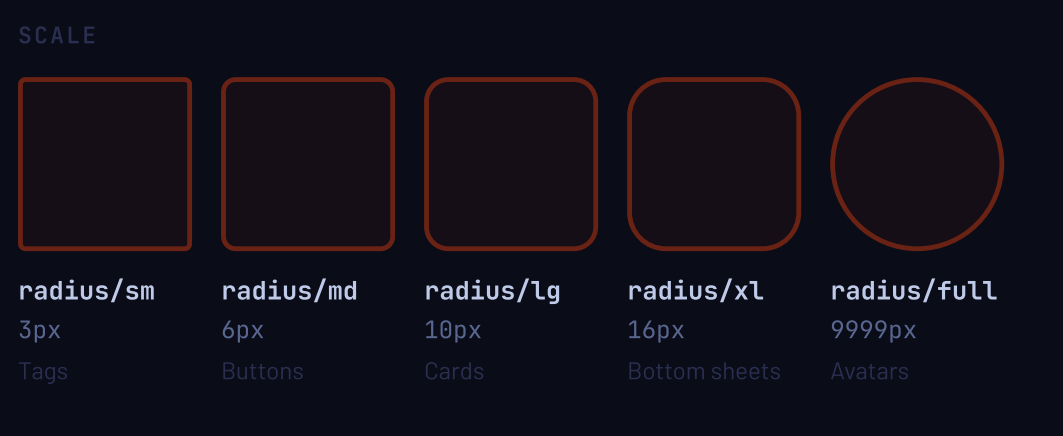
space/1-32	4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64, 80, 96, 128 px	
spacing/chip-x	space/2 — 8px	Tag, badge, tier chip horizontal pad
spacing/chip-y	space/1 — 4px	Tag, badge, tier chip vertical pad
spacing/component-x	space/4 — 16px	Nav items, list rows, input horizontal pad
spacing/component-y	space/3 — 12px	Nav items, list rows, input vertical pad
spacing/component-gap	space/3 — 12px	Gap between inline component elements
spacing/card-padding	space/5 — 20px	Card internal padding (all sides)
spacing/card-gap	space/4 — 16px	Gap between sections within a card
spacing/section	space/20 — 80px	Default vertical gap between page sections
spacing/section-tight	space/16 — 64px	Dense pages (admin, data tables)
spacing/page-gutter	clamp(1rem, 5vw, 2.5rem)	Responsive horizontal page margin
spacing/page-max	80rem — 1280px	Max content width

03 · RADIUS

Five-step scale · nesting rule

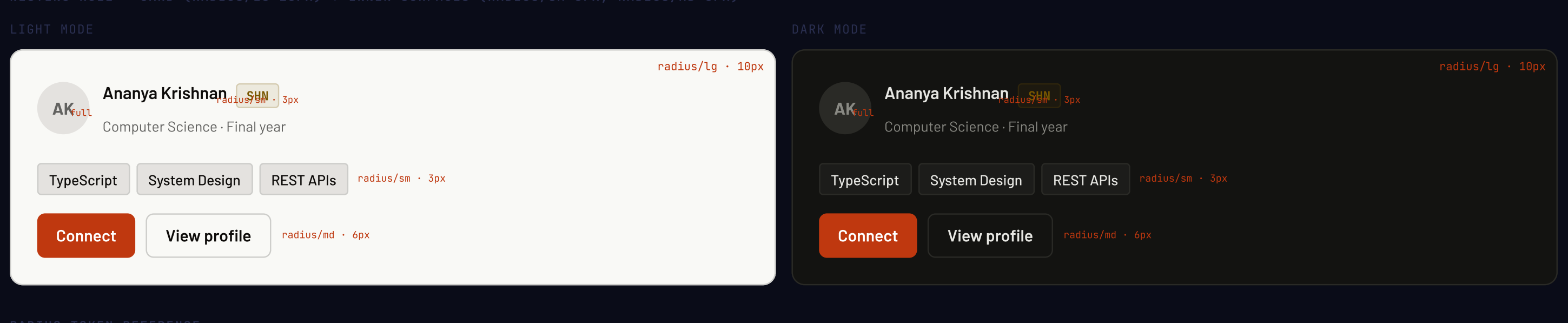
Cards use radius/lg (10px). Any surface nested inside a card — chip, code block, inner panel — uses radius/sm (3px) or radius/md (6px). Never the same radius nested inside itself. The decrease in radius signals containment hierarchy without requiring additional stroke weight.

SCALE



NESTING RULE — CARD (RADIUS/LG 10PX) → INNER SURFACES (RADIUS/SM 3PX, RADIUS/MD 6PX)

LIGHT MODE | DARK MODE



RADIUS TOKEN REFERENCE

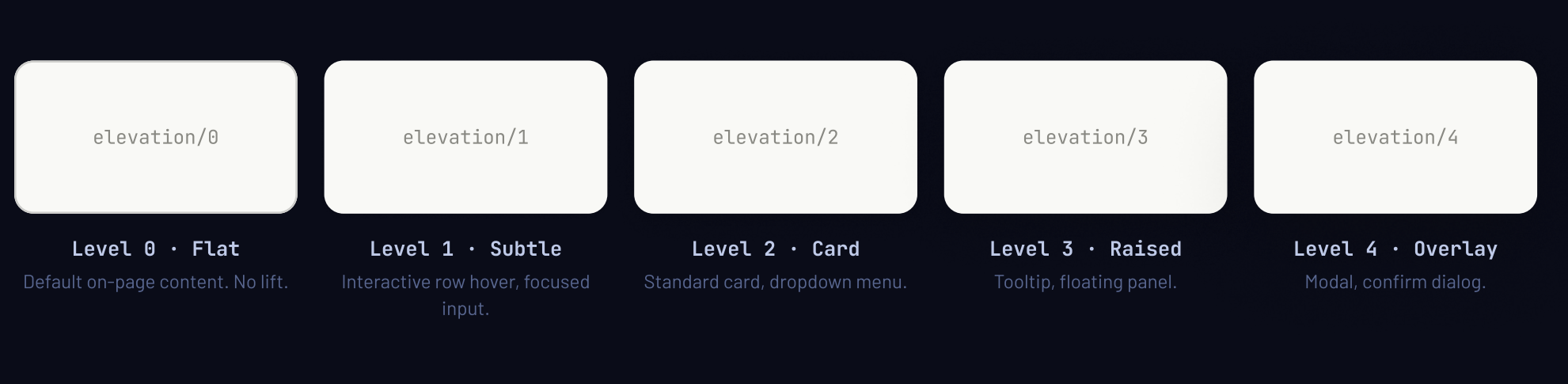
radius/none	0	Flush edges, e.g., full-bleed banners, table cells
radius/sm	3px	Tags, chips, code blocks, inner card surfaces
radius/md	6px	Buttons, inputs, select, interactive controls
radius/lg	10px	Cards, panels, dialogs — outer container
radius/xl	16px	Bottom sheets, large overlays
radius/full	9999px	Avatars, pill buttons, progress bars

04 · ELEVATION

Warm-tinted shadows · fill-first dark mode

Light mode shadows use neutral-950 (#0E0D0B) at low opacity — the same warm tint as the text stack, not generic black. Real offset + directional blur reads as depth; a zero-offset colored glow is decoration. Dark mode reverses the strategy: background fills and borders carry the depth signal; box-shadows only appear at level 3+ where they can actually register on a near-black surface.

LIGHT MODE — ALL FIVE LEVELS



Level 0 · Flat Default on-page content. No lift.

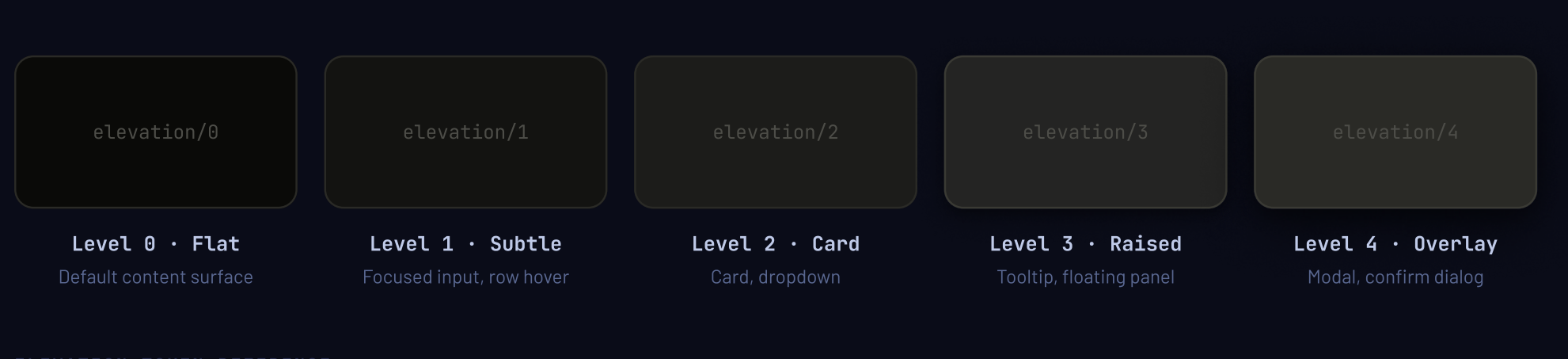
Level 1 · Subtle Interactive row hover, focused input.

Level 2 · Card Standard card, dropdown menu.

Level 3 · Raised Tooltip, floating panel.

Level 4 · Overlay Modal, confirm dialog.

DARK MODE — BORDER + FILL STRATEGY (SHADOW BARELY READS ON NEAR-BLACK SURFACES)



Level 0 · Flat Default content surface

Level 1 · Subtle Focused input, row hover

Level 2 · Card Card, dropdown

Level 3 · Raised Tooltip, floating panel

Level 4 · Overlay Modal, confirm dialog

ELEVATION TOKEN REFERENCE

shadow/0	none	Flat. Border (level 0 dark) or borderless (light).
shadow/1	0 1px 2px rgba(14,13,11,.05), 0 1px 3px rgba(14,13,11,.04)	Light: subtle lift. Dark: surface fill only.
shadow/2	0 2px 6px rgba(14,13,11,.06), 0 4px 14px rgba(14,13,11,.06)	Light: card. Dark: elevated fill only.
shadow/3	0 4px 12px rgba(14,13,11,.08), 0 8px 28px rgba(14,13,11,.09)	Light: tooltip/panel. Dark: shadow registers at this level.
shadow/4	0 8px 24px rgba(14,13,11,.10), 0 20px 52px rgba(14,13,11,.12)	Light: modal. Dark: heaviest shadow, used sparingly.
shadow/inset	inset 0 1px 2px rgba(14,13,11,.06)	Input well, pressed state.

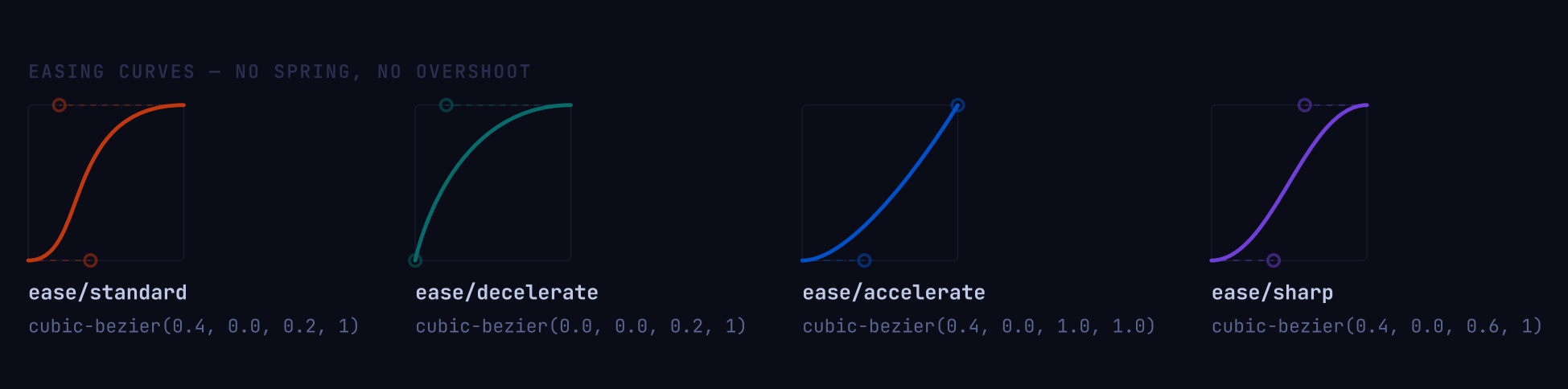
Dark mode philosophy: At levels 0–2, depth is communicated by background color progression (#0A0A09 → #131311 → #1D1D1A) plus border strengthening. Box shadows are suppressed because the contrast between shadow and near-black surface approaches zero. At levels 3–4, a small rgba(0,0,0) shadow is added because even on dark surfaces, the *directional* cue from a real offset reads as spatial without depending on contrast.

05 · MOTION

Restrained easing · no bounce, no spring

Every easing curve decelerates rather than overshoots. The tone is credible-over-hype: motion confirms an action or reveals information, it does not celebrate it. Duration scales from 120ms micro-interactions to a single 500ms signature moment reserved for proof events.

EASING CURVES — NO SPRING, NO OVERSHOOT



TOKEN REFERENCE

duration/instant	0ms	Error text appearing, immediate boolean feedback
duration/fast	120ms	Button press, checkbox tick, hover color shift
duration/base	200ms	Most transitions — color, opacity, border, shadow
duration/slow	300ms	Dropdown reveal, panel slide, modal fade
duration/deliberate	500ms	Signature moment only — the Verified Stamp
ease/standard	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0.0, 0.2, 1)	Color, opacity, most state changes
ease/decelerate	cubic-bezier(0.0, 0.0, 0.2, 1)	Elements entering viewport or confirming
ease/accelerate	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0.0, 1.0, 1.0)	Elements leaving — toast dismiss, drawer close
ease/sharp	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0.0, 0.6, 1)	Switches, tabs, toggles — snappy but not instant

SIGNATURE MOMENT — "VERIFIED STAMP" (CLICK TO TRIGGER)

When a contribution entry receives its verified mark, the animation runs as three sequential signals timed to feel deliberate, not decorative:

The left border sweeps *top-to-bottom* at full duration (500ms, ease/decelerate) — reads as a seal being applied

The shield icon stamps in simultaneously, scaling 0.5 → 1.03 → 1.0 — a slight settle without spring

The row background tints to verified-subtle (300ms, ease/standard) — the record is now marked

The "Verified" text slides in at +200ms delay (300ms, ease/decelerate) — the label arrives after the visual proof

No bounce. No spring. The motion communicates permanence — something that cannot be undone.